

Oracle EBS Report – Task Steps Documentation

Task Overview

The assignment: **create an .rtf report based on a Master-Detail report** in Oracle E-Business Suite (EBS) — Master = **DEPT** (department), Detail = **EMP** (employees) — built with Oracle Reports Builder for the data model and Oracle BI Publisher (Template Builder for Word) for the RTF layout. Two specific requirements were given:

- **Group By: DEPTNO** — each department (the master record) appears once, with all of its employees (the detail records) listed together underneath it in one continuous table.
- **Sort By: DNAME** — when multiple departments appear, they are ordered alphabetically by department name.

The report pulls from the standard **EMP** and **DEPT** tables (EMPNO, ENAME, JOB, MGR, HIREDATE, SAL, COMM, DEPTNO, DNAME, LOC).

Step 1 — Data Model / Query Setup (Reports Builder)

In Oracle Reports Builder, the query behind the Master-Detail data model was confirmed/updated so that:

- The master group (**G_3**) is built on **DEPTNO**, producing one record per department.
- The detail group (**G_1**) is nested under it, one row per employee in that department.
- The query includes:

```
GROUP BY DEPTNO, DNAME, LOC, ENAME, JOB, MGR, HIREDATE, SAL, COMM, EMPNO  
ORDER BY DNAME, ENAME
```

The **ORDER BY DNAME, ENAME** was the key fix here: it sorts departments alphabetically by name (per the Sort By: DNAME requirement) and sorts employees alphabetically within each department, which also prevented the data from arriving in a scattered order that later confused the template grouping.

Step 2 — Run the Report and Export the Sample XML

1. In EBS, ran the concurrent request for the report (e.g. `KAWTHER_MASTER_DETAIL`) from the **Requests** window.
2. Opened the generated XML output (View Output / XML), which confirmed the correct nested structure: `G_3 (DEPTNO) → LIST_G_1 → G_1` (one entry per employee).
3. Saved this XML as a sample data file for the template builder: **File → Save As**, type **Web Page, XML only**, file name ending in `.xml` (e.g. `KAWTHER_MASTER_DETAIL_230926.xml`).

This XML file is only used as sample data to build the Word template against — it is not opened as a Word document.

Step 3 — Build the RTF Template in Word (BI Publisher Table Wizard)

1. Opened a **blank** Word document and, from the **BI Publisher** add-in tab, used **Data → Load XML Data** to load the saved sample XML.
2. Ran **Table Wizard** and, on the grouping screen:
 - **Group By = Dname** (this is the field that structures one block per department).
 - **Then By** left **empty** — critical step. Adding a second field here (e.g. `Ename`) would create a *nested* group per employee, breaking each employee out into its own mini-table instead of a row.
3. On the field-selection screen, added the detail fields (`Loc`, `Ename`, `Job`, `Mgr`, `Hiredate`, `Sal`, `Comm`, `Empno`, `Deptno1`) as ordinary row fields, not as additional grouping levels.
4. On the **Sort By** screen (row-level sort within each department group): since `Dname` isn't offered there (it's already used as the group field), chose **Ename, Ascending** so employees list alphabetically inside each department. This step is optional/cosmetic — it doesn't affect the department grouping.
5. Clicked **Finish**.

Result: a single table per department, with the department name as the group header and each employee as a row underneath — matching the Group By: `DEPTNO` / Sort By: `DNAME` requirement.

Step 4 — Issue Found and Fixed: Broken Grouping

Problem: the first attempt at the template produced a separate mini-table for every *employee name* instead of one table per department — the report did not match the required Group By: DEPTNO structure.

Root cause: the Table Wizard had been run with **Ename** set as a second-level group ("Then By"), which is a nested group, not a row — so each employee's name created its own group header and table.

Second issue: when re-running the wizard to fix it, the new (correct) table was built on top of the *same* Word document that still contained the old broken table, resulting in two table blocks stacked in one document (`group G_1 by DEPTN01 ... end G_1 by DEPTN01` followed by `group G_1 by DNAME ... end G_1 by DNAME`).

Fix: started over in a completely new, blank Word document — reloaded the XML sample data, and rebuilt the table from scratch with the correct settings (Group By = Dname, no Then By). This avoided any leftover/duplicate blocks and produced a single, clean table structure.

Step 5 — Save, Upload, and Run

1. Saved the corrected Word template via **File → Save As**, type **Rich Text Format (.rtf)** (or Word 97-2003 .doc, per the Template Manager's accepted format).
2. In EBS, went to **XML Publisher Administrator → Templates** (Template Manager) and **uploaded** the new .rtf file, replacing the previous version.
3. Went back to the **Requests** window and submitted the report again (**Submit a New Request**).
4. Opened the output and verified: the **ACCOUNTING** department (and other departments) each rendered as one continuous table, with every employee listed as a row underneath — confirming the Group By: DEPTNO / Sort By: DNAME requirement was met.

Final Result

The generated report output showed the **ACCOUNTING** department as a single continuous table (one group header, one table), with all department employees — including the newly inserted record — listed as rows underneath, matching the task's Group By: DEPTNO and Sort By: DNAME requirements.

Status: the RTF Master-Detail report is technically complete and ready for submission. A final visual check of the output after the last data insert (to confirm the new record displays correctly) is still recommended before final submission.